arrows at him, but none hurt. They gave up and ran away. It was indeed audacious of him to swim in the mighty Sindh all alone with no one behind, on a bare-backed horse, and to chase off a foe and thereby occupy his ground. Babur calls this, ‘a mightily bold deed!’

Now look at the irony, after he drove the enemies away from the island, other soldiers followed and returned with booty—clothes and droves of various sorts. Babur had raised Qul-i-bāyazīd from the position of cook to that of a royal taster in the past—his courage and kindness were always rewarded. This time Babur gave him a position full of bounty, favour and promotions. Babur says, ‘In truth, he was worthy of honour and advancement[*].’

Babur and two of his men marched down the water of Sindh. Babur’s men had now knocked their horses away perpetually for galloping off on raids. They usually took cattle. In the plain, they exclusively took a lot of sheep and clothes as bounty. However, once they left the plains, they had nothing but cattle.

The raids along the Sindh River were rather barbaric. Even merely a servant would bring in around 400 chopped heads. Many of these would rot on the roads.

The Westward March

They had already made three more marches along the Sindh River. They stopped moving forward when they came opposite the Pīr Kānū’s tomb. Babur decided to pay his obeisance. When some of his badly injured soldiers tried to pay their tributes, it disgusted Babur to such an extent that he ordered immediately them to have them chopped off into pieces.[3] Babur observed that this tomb lay on the skirt of one of the Mehtar Sulaimān mountains and was accorded great honour in Hindustan.

They began to march from Pīr Kānū and dismounted at the Pawat pass, lying in the bed of a torrent in Dūkī (sub-district of Qandahār). After they left this camp, around thirty followers of Fāẕil Kūkūldāsh, the *dārogha* of Sīwī and the retainer of Shāh Beg were brought in. They were sent to perhaps look at Babur’s activities. But after having familiarised with the whole matter, Babur decided to let them go with their horses and arms as he was on good terms with Shāh Beg. After one night’s halt, they reached a village named Chūtīālī.

Babur’s men had constantly galloped off to raid, before reaching the Sindh water and all along its bank. They did not leave horses behind as there was plenty of green food and corn for them. However, after they left the river and set out for Pīr Kānū, there was no trace of green food. They would find only a little land under green crops every two or three marches, but no corn for the